

CS-012 Purchasing & Reimbursement

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Title	Purchasing & Reimbursement (Composites)
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Supersedes	Purchasing-by-osmosis

Approvals

Role	Name	Date
Author	Simon Starbuck (drafted with Claude, SN6 Resources)	2026-07-12
Reviewer	simon (reviewer agent)	
Approver (Composites Lead)		

Revision history

Rev	Date	Author	Description of change
A	2026-07-12	Claude	Initial outline, documents the team-wide process as pinned in #purchasing (2025-10-26) + composites-specific rules
B	2026-07-28	Claude	Language pass: fewer em dashes for rhythm variety, no content change.
C	2026-08-03	Claude	New §7.8: the label printer as a standing purchase request, with the payback argument and why the cheaper and dearer options were both rejected (CS-001 §5).

1. Purpose

In SN5 basically all of our ~\$5.3k spend went through the lead's personal card, reimbursements were slow, and needs that surfaced late turned into rush-shipping blowouts (\$400 of shipping on \$120 of ACP rods, PP-08). The team-wide purchasing process actually exists and is fine; composites members just didn't know it. This doc restates it and adds our ordering calendar.

2. Scope

All composites purchases and reimbursements; sponsor material requests at outline level.

3. References

Ref	Document	Where
R1	Team purchasing rules (Shailen Kumar, pinned in #purchasing, 2025-10-26)	Slack — re-verify tiers/names each fall
R2	PP-02, PP-08 RCAs	FEB-COMP-PP-001
R3	CS-011 (min-stock triggers)	CS-011

4. Definitions

Approval tiers, reimbursement form (pinned in #purchasing channel description), purchaser (a member who fronts money and gets reimbursed).

5. Equipment & Materials

None — process standard.

6. Safety

No physical hazards. Financial safety rule: nobody fronts more than they are comfortable waiting ~a month to get back (R1: deposits take up to a month).

7. Procedure (outline — names/tiers as of 2025-26; re-verify each season)

7.1 Approval

1. **Every purchase gets approval BEFORE buying**, posted in #purchasing: <\$50 → subteam lead; \$50–250 → division lead; >\$250 → President/VP (R1).

7.2 Reimbursement

1. **Reimbursement:** photo of the itemized receipt (card statement alone is NOT enough) + card statement (redact other lines, keep name/address/last-4/purchase/date); submit the pinned form within **1 month**; no Venmo/Zelle/cash/gift cards; Amazon must show Shipped/Delivered; categorize under the subteam **using** the material (R1).

7.3 Distributed purchasers

1. The lead designates 2–3 members (with the finance lead’s knowledge) as regular purchasers so no single card is the team’s float (PP-08).

7.4 Order calendar (composites)

1. **Order calendar:** September, bulk consumables + first Easy Composites basket (6-week lead, customs margin, PP-02); December, spring-semester basket; rolling, min-stock triggers from CS-011 stock walks. A shared “basket” doc collects wants before each EC order (SN5 practice: “add what you would like by TONIGHT”; make it a standing doc instead).

7.5 Rush orders

1. Any order with >2× shipping-to-item ratio needs the lead’s explicit sign-off with the alternative (wait/borrow/local) stated. Make the \$400-shipping decision consciously.

7.6 Sponsor asks

1. **Sponsor asks:** batch material requests through the lead (Airtech/Sigmatex/Coastal/ACP/Rexco contacts live with PM); never let sponsor stock run to zero before asking, since sponsors have lead times too.

7.7 Season close

1. All reimbursements submitted by the finance deadline (SN5: July 4 hard cutoff; unpaid-form escalation window to July 14 — dates change yearly, check #purchasing).

7.8 Standing request: label printer

Filed here rather than left implicit, because CS-001 Rev C's §5 stops being self-funding at exactly one line item.

Item	Brother PT-D610BT label printer, plus 3 × TZe-251 24 mm laminated tape and 1 × TZe-231 12 mm
Cost	~\$115 hardware, ~\$76 tape. Year one \$191; recurring \$50/yr at a measured ~480 labels per season
Requested by	Composites

Justification. The shop's current identification method is handwriting on tape, and a standard Sharpie is soluble in the isopropyl alcohol used at every stage of CS-004 and CS-009. So the labels the team already relies on are being erased by the team's own cleaning step. A single mis-identified 8-ply carbon part costs roughly \$300–600 in fabric and resin plus about 20 person-hours to remake, and a mis-identified mold costs a machining slot at RFS. Payback is one prevented mix-up.

Why not cheaper. The zero-cost path (Avery sheets on the office laser with a packing-tape overlamine, CS-001 §7.8) is retained as the documented fallback, not eliminated. It works; it is just slower per label and one grade less durable.

Why not more. Thermal-transfer-on-polyester (Zebra ZD421t class, ~\$681) has more chemical margin than we need. There is no oven and no post-cure, so maximum service temperature is shop ambient, and laminated TZe tape is rated $-80\text{ }^{\circ}\text{C}$ to $+150\text{ }^{\circ}\text{C}$ and tested against solvent abrasion. Direct-thermal printers (Rollo and similar) are **disqualified**, not merely rejected: direct thermal is dissolved and smeared by IPA, so those labels would be blank within months in this shop.

Model choice. The PT-D610BT over the app-only PT-P710BT because it has an on-device keyboard and runs on AC. In a shop whose roster turns over every May, a printer that only works from one specific person's paired phone stops working the summer that person graduates. Both take identical tape, so it is reversible.

8. Quality checks / acceptance criteria

Check	Target	Method	Record where
Pre-approval on every purchase	100%	#purchasing thread exists	Slack
Reimbursements in 1 month	100%	Purchaser self-check	Form records
No unplanned rush shipping	Lead sign-off recorded when it happens	#purchasing thread	Slack

9. Records

#purchasing threads + the Budget sheet (kept as the season's spend view; the WO BOM fields give per-part material cost).